
accelerate
collaborate
innovate
communicate
palm
PalmSource
Conference 2000

The Zen of Palm 2000

Michael Mace
Chief Competitive Officer
& VP of Product Planning

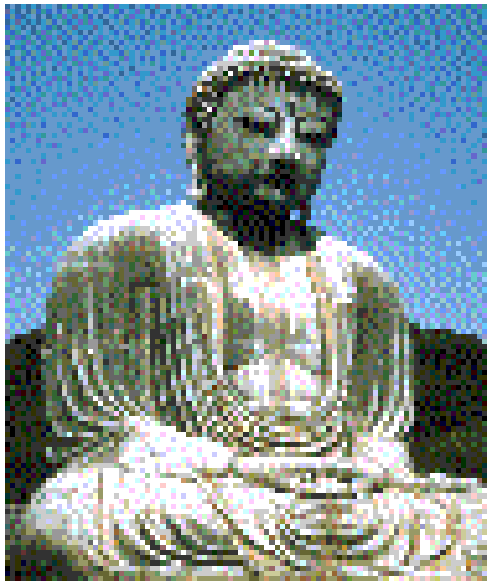
Special thanks to Rob Hitani

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Transitions

- From PCs to handhelds
- From small to large
- From devices only to devices, OS, services
- From proprietary to licensed
- From division to independent

- What stays the same?
- What changes?



the zen of Palm

product design for the soul

The path to enlightenment

- Palm design is a way of life
- Embrace simplicity
- Convert the unbelievers or perish
- The secret lies in 3 riddles



Riddle #1

Q. How can a dinosaur learn to fly?



Riddle #1

A. Only by abandoning the essence of the dinosaur.



The essence of PCs

Creating information
More features are always better

“You want people to have more processing power, a bigger hard drive, more DRAM, a better user experience...”

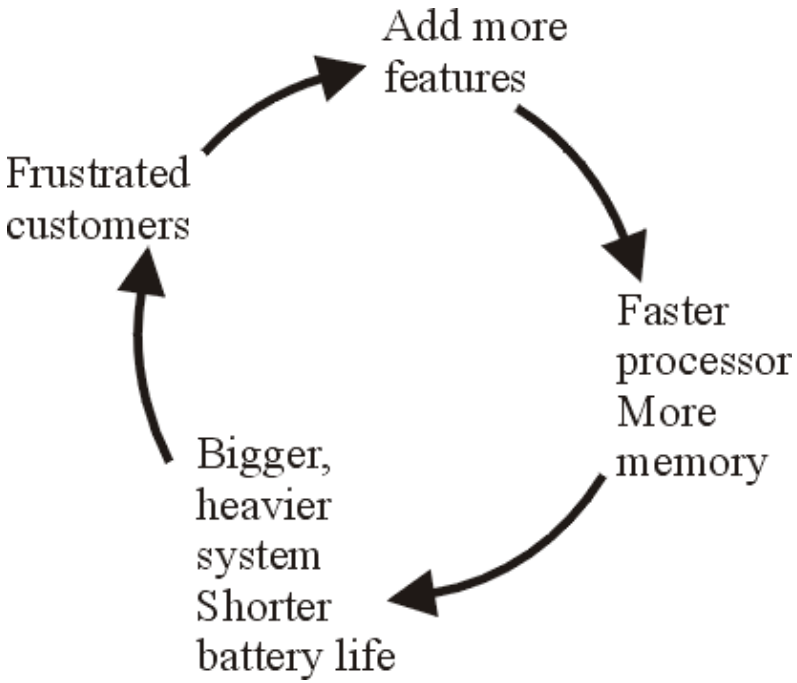
Craig Barrett, CEO Intel





The essence of Handhelds

Managing and *accessing* information on the go
More features weigh you down!



Mindset

- PC
  - Productivity, baby
  - Do more than the other guy (zero-sum)
  - “If I send more e-mails, I’m winning”
- Handheld
  - Comfort in a fast-paced world
  - Be smart, be connected
  - “I know exactly what’s going on.”
- Stockbrokers vs. Jedi knights



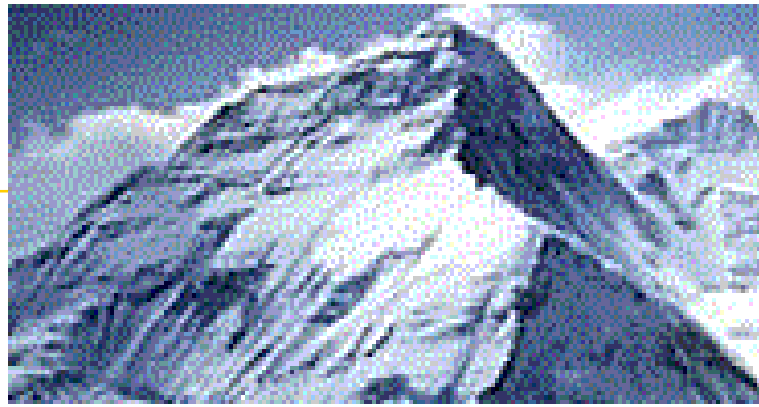
Why we're a problem for PC companies

- Their basic instincts lead to failure in our world
- T. rex rules the jungle, the eagle rules the sky
- Our challenge is to teach the bird's perspective to a reptile world



Riddle #2

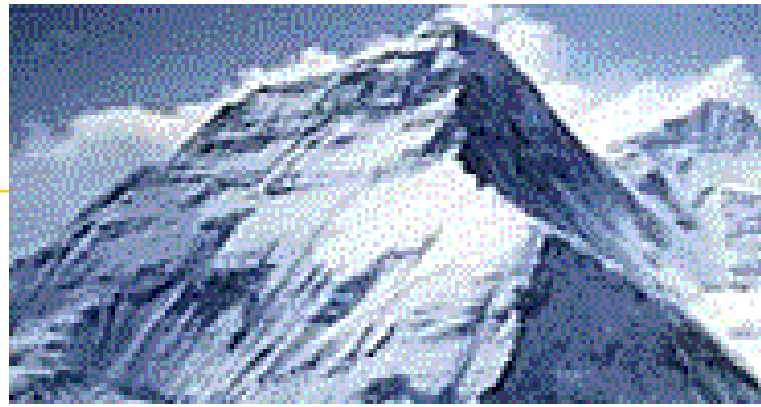
Q. How do you put a mountain in a teacup?





Riddle #2

A. Why put a mountain in a teacup?

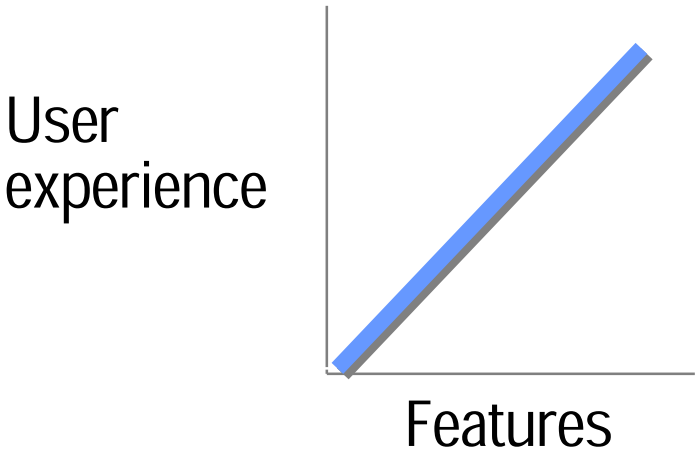




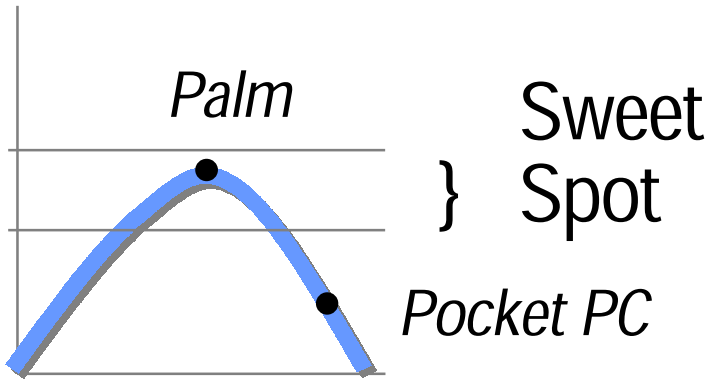
Nirvana: the Sweet Spot

- Wearable
  - Fit in a pocket of purse without thought
  - Worry-free battery life
- Simple
  - Get to your information *instantly*
- Connected
  - Get whatever you need whenever and wherever you want it

New features



PC world



Handheld world

Riddle #3

Q. How do you keep a lizard from crawling off a cliff?



Riddle #3

A. Move the cliff.



“Pragmatic Innovation”

- Steps
  - 1. Find a problem (Hole)
  - 2. Find the *simplest* solution (Peg)
  - 3. Punt the rest



“Technology that doesn’t suck”
(“Delight the customer”)

1. Finding Holes

- Don’t just follow what customers ask for
  - They don’t know what’s possible
  - “I want speech recognition”
  - “I want full Web browsing”
- Don’t just follow the competition
- Study what customers *do*

Solving the problem: Solutions vs. features

- Wrong: “How do I enhance the feature?”
- Right: “What is the user trying to do?”
- Focus on the 80/20 rule
  - Don’t add complexity to resolve fringe cases
  - (Many industry analysts are fringe cases)
- The answer may be illogical
  - Dedicating address book button to beaming a business card

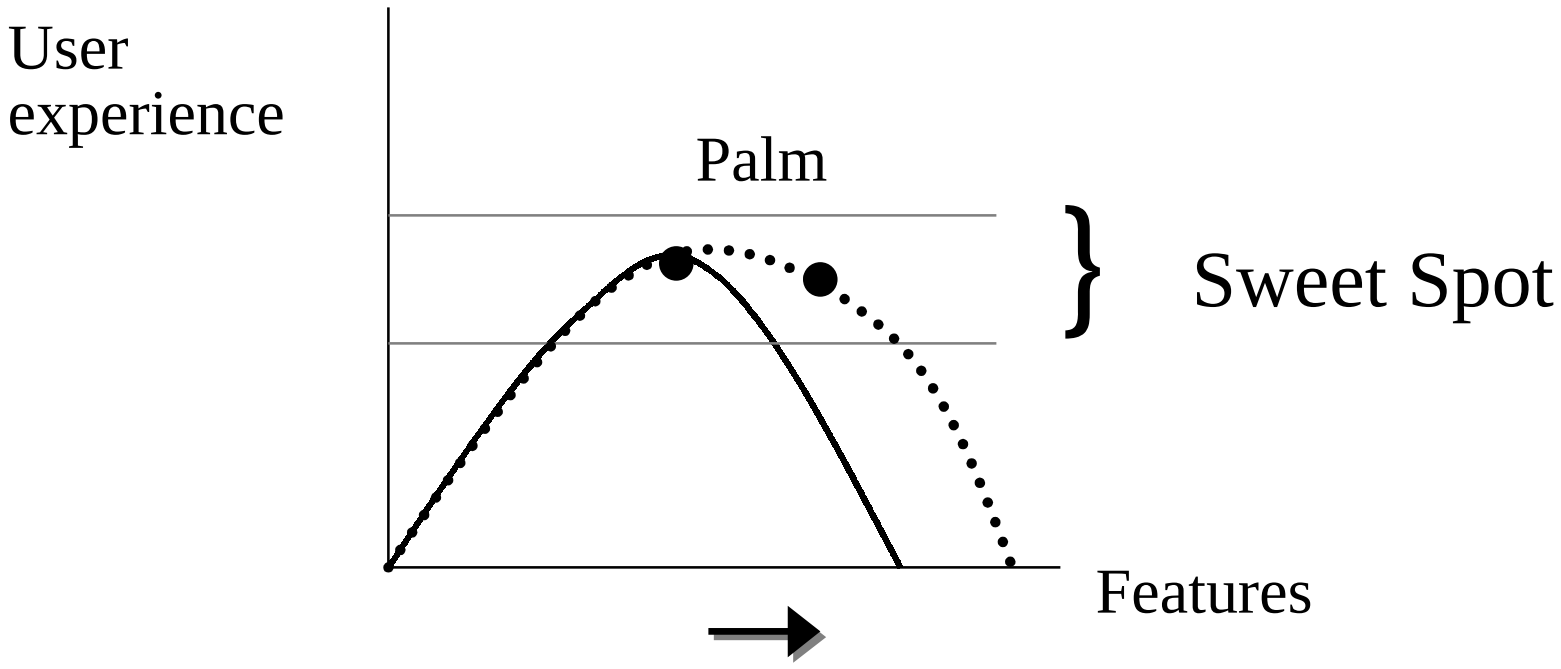
Simplicity wins

- Robust functionality is a cop-out for handheld products
  - Define a product like packing a backpack
- Most customers ignore most features
  - But in the PC world there's no downside to extra features
  - In handhelds, there is
- Simplicity *is* power, because the ultimate power is getting something you can use

Power = getting the job done

- Palm's paradoxes:
  - slower processor ➔ better performance
  - smaller batteries ➔ longer battery life
  - less functionality ➔ more useful
  - no bells and whistles ➔ coolest product

How to add features over time



Pragmatic innovation lets us *shift the curve!*

How to decide

- Technology that's not ready for prime time...yet
  - Video
  - Speech recognition
  - Full browsing
- Technology that's arriving now
  - Wireless text and small graphics
  - Sound (?)
- When features ready for prime time
  - Technology fits within the sweet spot
  - It solves a genuine customer problem

The Zen approach

- Abandon PC instincts
- Strive for simplicity
- Forego pleasures of material features
- Focus on the customer’s inner tranquility





The zen of Kicking Microsoft's Butt

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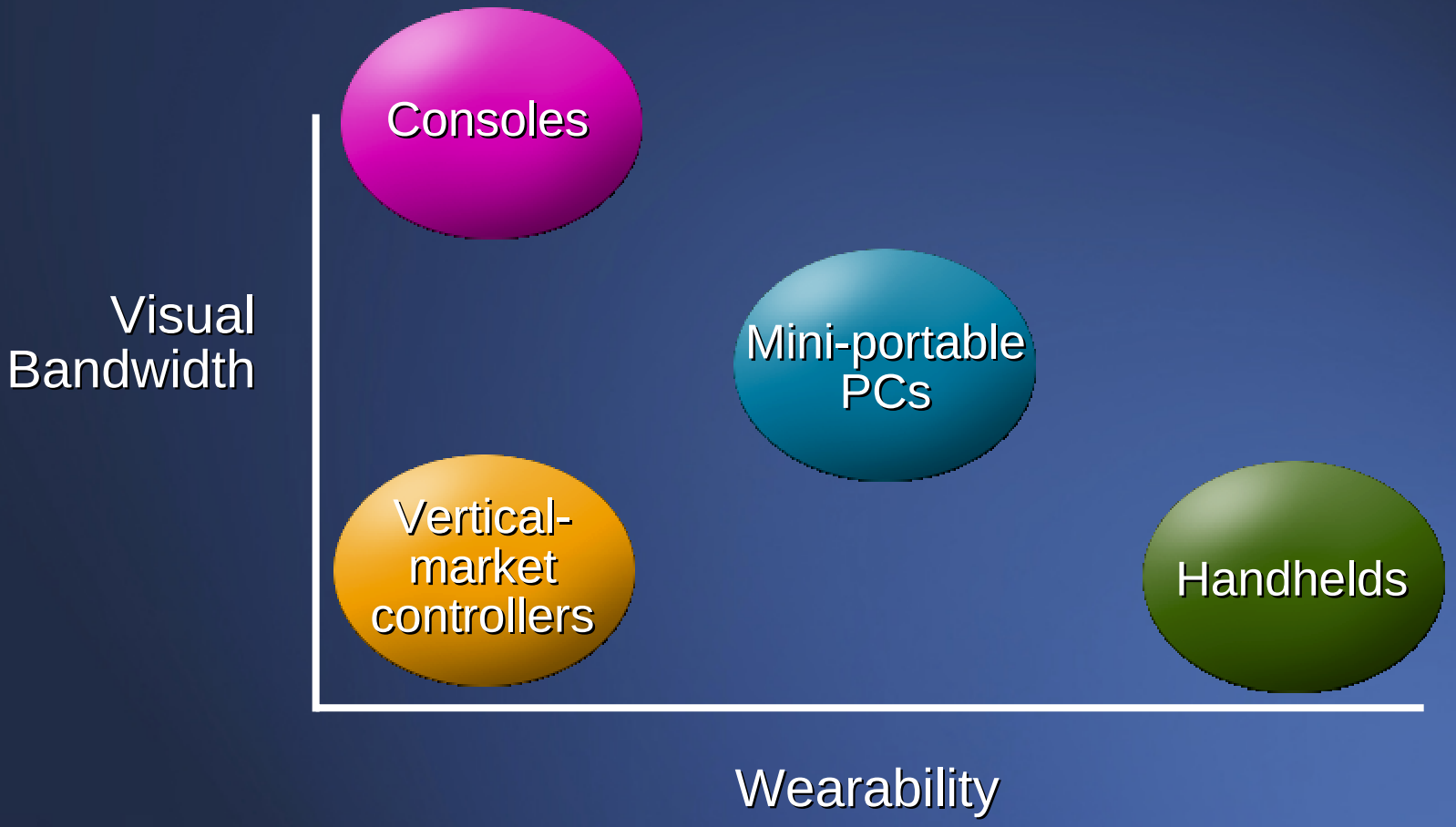
Where We're Going Next

- Goal
  - Set the *platform standard* for mobile information management and *profit* from it
- Vision
  - Palm is how you manage the information in your life
  - A Palm™ handheld in every pocket and purse

How We Get There

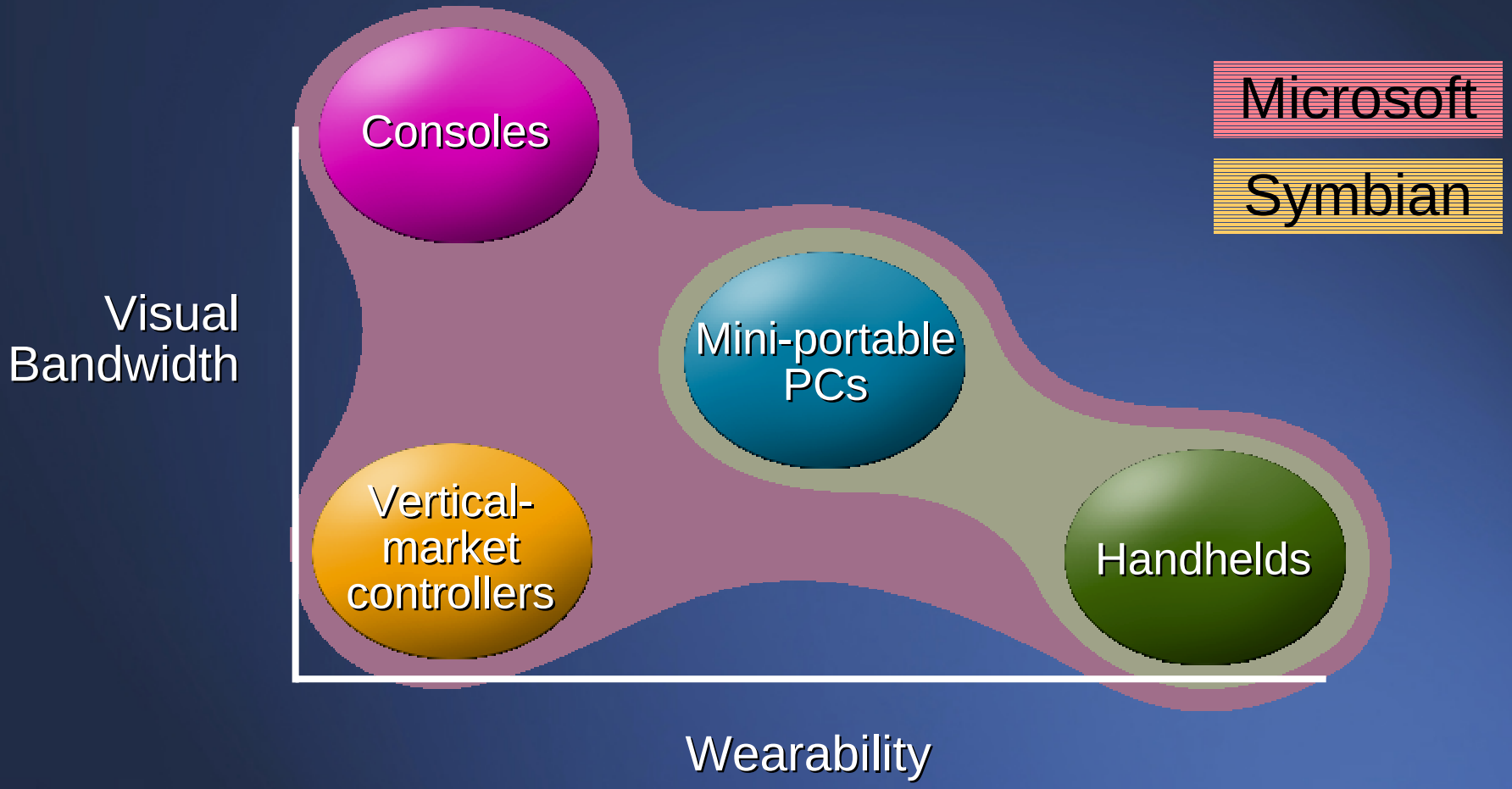
- Setting the platform standard
  - Be the interface and APIs that everyone uses
    - Thousands of applications
  - There can be only one winner
    - Bandwagon effect
- Making a profit
  - Handhelds, OS, accessories, content and services
    - Handheld margins will drop

Information Appliances

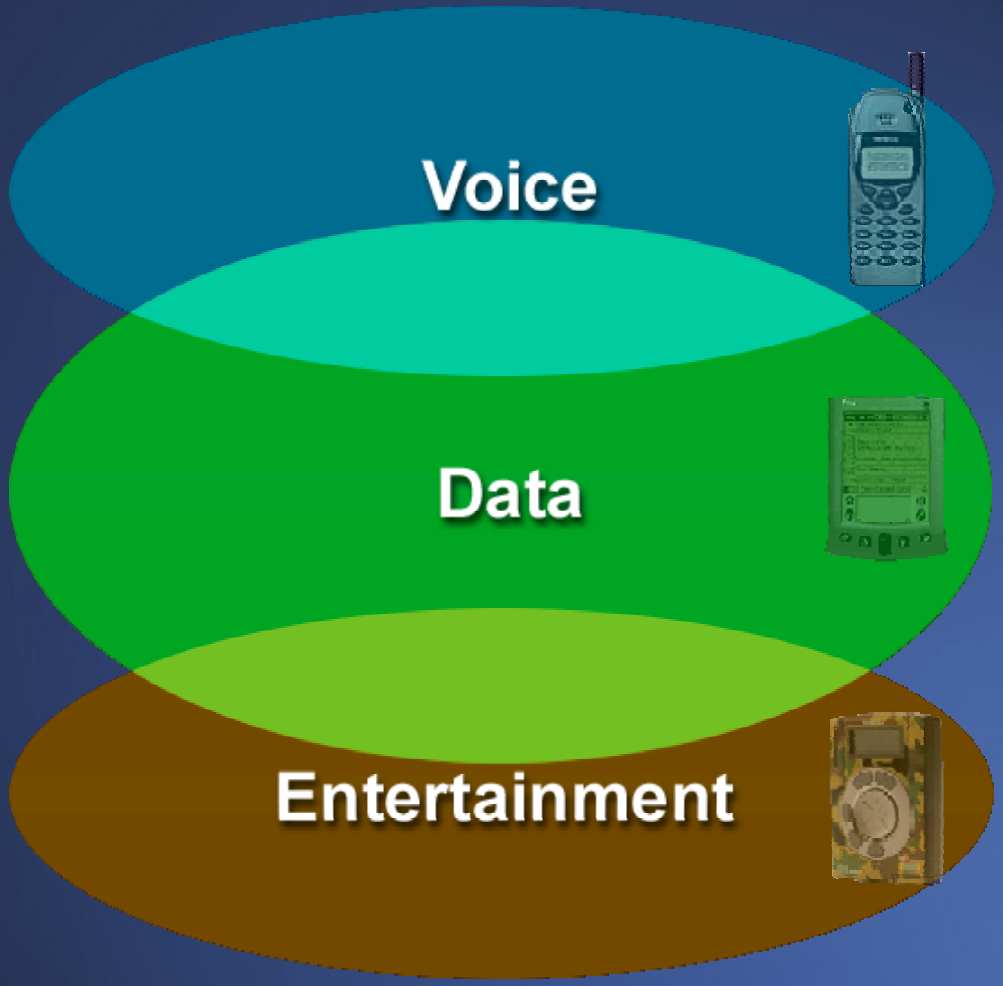


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Competitors



Future of Handhelds



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How to Win

- Pearls from our ancestors
  - It's a different form of computing
  - Wearability and simplicity are the most important features
  - Must teach our philosophy to the world
- New insights
  - The competition will eventually "get it"
  - Must share control (and revenue) in order to set the standard
  - Must make money from more than just devices

What to Tell Your Friends

- Palm OS® is the handheld standard
  - A new form of computing focused on info management, not creation
  - Thousands of applications, >70% share
- Why we're successful
  - Simpler
  - More wearable
  - More mobile (anytime, anywhere)


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